National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Medford, OK	**Accident Number:**	DFW08CA047
Date & Time:	12/20/2007, 1900 CST	**Registration:**	N5957F
Aircraft:	Cessna 210	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	3 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The private pilot attempted a night landing on an unlighted runway. Prior to landing, he said he tried to activate the runway lights, but was unable to turn the lights on. The pilot noted that since there was moonlight and he was familiar with the airport; he elected to land without the runway lights. He reported that he thought he could see the runway, and that he was on the runway, until "he felt the nose-wheel sink." The airplane came to rest inverted. An inspection of the runway lighting system revealed that the lights were not functioning properly.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The pilot's decision to attempt a night landing without runway lighting. A contributing factor was inoperative runway lights.

Findings

Occurrence #1: ON GROUND/WATER ENCOUNTER WITH TERRAIN/WATER
Phase of Operation: LANDING - ROLL

Findings
1. LIGHT CONDITION - NIGHT
2. (C) IN-FLIGHT PLANNING/DECISION - INADEQUATE - PILOT IN COMMAND
3. (F) AIRPORT FACILITIES,RUNWAY EDGE LIGHTS - INOPERATIVE

Factual Information

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Commercial	**Age:**	59, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine Land	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt
Instrument Rating(s):	Airplane	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	No
Medical Certification:	Class 3 With Waivers/Limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	12/01/2007
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	07/01/2006
Flight Time:	1196 hours (Total, all aircraft), 22 hours (Total, this make and model), 1196 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 6 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 5 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft), 5 hours (Last 24 hours, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Cessna	**Registration:**	N5957F
Model/Series:	210	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	No
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	21058957
Landing Gear Type:	Retractable - Tricycle	**Seats:**	6
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	02/01/2007, Annual	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	3400 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	2650 Hours	**Engine Manufacturer:**	Continental
ELT:	Installed, not activated	**Engine Model/Series:**	IO-520
Registered Owner:	3D Well Service	**Rated Power:**	285 hp
Operator:	Don Kirby	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Night
Observation Facility, Elevation:	KWDG	**Distance from Accident Site:**	25 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	1850 CDT	**Direction from Accident Site:**	180°
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Scattered	**Visibility**	10 Miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	Calm /	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:		**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	29.84 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	4°C / 1°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	HOBBS, NM (HOB)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Medford, OK	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:		**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	MEDFORD MUNI (OK68)	**Runway Surface Type:**	Asphalt
Airport Elevation:		**Runway Surface Condition:**	Unknown
Runway Used:	17	**IFR Approach:**	Unknown
Runway Length/Width:	3007 ft / 60 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Unknown

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	2 None	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	3 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	36.787778, -97.742778

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Craig R Hatch	**Report Date:**	02/28/2008
Additional Participating Persons:	William Witten; Oklahoma City, Oklahoma		
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB), established in 1967, is an independent federal agency mandated by Congress through the Independent Safety Board Act of 1974 to investigate transportation accidents, determine the probable causes of the accidents, issue safety recommendations, study transportation safety issues, and evaluate the safety effectiveness of government agencies involved in transportation. The NTSB makes public its actions and decisions through accident reports, safety studies, special investigation reports, safety recommendations, and statistical reviews.

The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.